33. The articles specified or included in any of the descriptions contained in the list annexed to this rule shall be deemed to be prohibited articles, within the meaning of section 42 and clause (12) of section 45 of the Prisons Act, 1894, unless any such article shall be –

(a) introduced into any jail,
(b) removed from any jail,
(c) supplied to any prisoner outside the limit of any jail, or
(d) received, possessed or transferred by any prisoner

with the permission of the Supdt. or other officer empowered by him in this behalf.

List of prohibited articles:

(1) Spirituous liquors of every description, ganja, bhang, opium, smack and other intoxicants.
(2) All explosive, intoxicating or poisonous substances and chemicals, whether fluid or solid, or whatever description, etc.

Charles Sobhraj had been first permitted a typewriter way back in 1978 by an assistant sessions judge, T. S. Oberoi, who was the trial judge in his YMCA passport case. Other prisoners had also been given this facility as is evinced by the fact that one Dr N. S. Jain was permitted one in 1977 and so was one Sunil Batra in 1979. As to Charles Sobhraj being served meat rations (230 grams), this was done on the express orders of the additional sessions judge, H. L. Malhotra, in 1990. All these orders were given much before Kiran came to Tihar. But one's selective reading of the rules to suit one's story constituted one way of selling sensationalism on the part of some news reporters.

In quick succession, yet another report of *The Hindustan Times* mentioned that Charles Sobhraj's lawyer, Debashish Mazumdar, after a meeting with him in jail, was caught trying to smuggle out the electronic typewriter that his client had been permitted to use in his cell. The matter was given an apparent slant that made it appear as if evidence against the IG (Prisons) was being removed. This ruse appears quite in keeping with the canard of disinformation that was being disseminated against her. What actually took place was that during his meeting with his lawyer in the Tamil Nadu Special Police guardroom, under the supervision of a TNSP subinspector, Charles Sobhraj had sought recorded permission from the SI to permit his lawyer to take out his electronic typewriter for repairs. An entry to this effect was made in the 'legal interview register' maintained at the high-security prison and he was then permitted to hand over the typewriter. If information about this incident was given to the *Hindustan Times* reporter, obviously, the relevant facts of the case were conveniently withheld and the story was thus filed with only insufficient inputs.

What came out to be more amusing was the fact of Charles Sobhraj being repeatedly called Kiran's 'friend'. This apparently emanated from the fact that he had stated to a reporter that, having given up a life of crime, he was going to turn to writing and that he was already working, among other things, on Kiran's Bedi's jail reforms in Tihar over the past two years. When Kiran was asked about this, she replied that being an intelligent human being who had spent quite some time in prison, Charles was in quite the right situation to be working on such a project if he had so decided. This view was given a different slant and made to appear as if Kiran had authorized her biography to be written by him. Naturally, in the eyes of her detractors, he became a 'friend' who had to be given any and all facilities to aid and abet her 'narcissism'. Much, therefore, was made of the typewriter issue to the extent that Kiran was now suddenly seen to be compromising security to achieve much shallower ends.